

NovaTech Remote Work and Distributed Team Policy (v3.2)

1. Purpose and Operational Philosophy

NovaTech operates as a distributed-first technology company. This policy defines eligibility rules, financial stipends, hardware allocation, working hours, and security requirements for all full-time employees and contractors.

Our philosophy prioritizes asynchronous communication, high documentation hygiene, and measurable output over physical presence.

2. Classification of Work Models and Eligibility

All NovaTech employees are assigned to one of three official work models upon offer acceptance:

Remote-First: Employees whose primary residential address is situated more than 50 miles from any designated NovaTech regional hub (New York, San Francisco, London, Austin). Remote-first employees work from home full-time.

Hybrid: Employees situated within 50 miles of a regional hub. Hybrid employees are required to work on-site at the hub 2 days per week on designated company collaboration days: Tuesdays and Thursdays. The remaining three days may be worked remotely.

Dedicated In-Office: Roles requiring direct physical access to hardware laboratories, IT shipping depots, or facilities infrastructure.

Full-time new hires become eligible for fully flexible remote scheduling immediately upon the successful completion of their mandatory 90-day probationary review.

3. Home Office Setup Stipend and Recurring Technology Allowance

To establish an ergonomic, productive home workspace, NovaTech provides every new full-time remote employee with a one-time Home Office Equipment Stipend of up to \$1,000 USD.

Eligible items for reimbursement under the setup stipend include motorized standing desks, ergonomic task chairs, external 4K monitors, monitor arms, ergonomic keyboards, mice, webcams, and noise-canceling headsets. Non-eligible items include decorative furniture, standing desk converters, audio speakers, and gaming peripherals.

Stipend claims must be submitted with itemized vendor receipts via Expensify within the employee's first 60 calendar days of employment.

In addition to the one-time setup stipend, all remote and hybrid employees receive a recurring Technology & Internet Allowance of \$600 USD per year (\$50 USD monthly), credited automatically on the final payroll cycle of each month to offset high-speed broadband costs.

4. Corporate Hardware Provisioning & Refresh Cadence

NovaTech IT procures, configures, and ships one primary corporate workstation to every employee prior to Day 1:

Engineering, Product Design, and Data Science personnel receive a 16-inch Apple MacBook Pro configured with Apple Silicon M3 Max, 32GB Unified Memory, and 1TB SSD.

Operations, Finance, Legal, and People Operations personnel receive a Lenovo ThinkPad X1 Carbon Gen 12 configured with Intel Core Ultra 7, 32GB RAM, and 512GB SSD.

All workstations are enrolled in automated Mobile Device Management (MDM) with mandatory full-disk encryption (FileVault on macOS, BitLocker on Windows). Primary

workstations are eligible for an automated hardware refresh every 36 months of active service.

5. Working Hours & Core Collaboration Window

To maintain predictable cross-functional communication across time zones, all distributed team members must maintain daily active availability on Slack during the Core Collaboration Window: 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM Eastern Standard Time (EST), Monday through Friday.

Flexible scheduling outside the core window is permitted with direct manager notification, provided team commitments, standups, and customer-facing deliverables are fulfilled.

6. International Remote Work & Coworking Day Passes

Employees in good standing may temporarily work from an international location outside their legal country of residence for up to 30 consecutive business days per calendar year. Requests must be submitted to People Operations at least 15 business days in advance to evaluate corporate tax Nexus and GDPR/cross-border data privacy rules.

For remote-first employees desiring occasional office space, NovaTech reimburses flexible on-demand coworking day passes (e.g. WeWork, Industrious) up to a maximum of \$150 USD per calendar month with Director pre-approval.